

Markdown Quick Reference Card

A concise syntax guide optimized for a single two-sided printout.

1. Headers & Layout

Element	Syntax Example	Rendered Look / Notes
Heading 1	<code># Header 1</code>	Main document or page title
Heading 2	<code>## Header 2</code>	Major section heading
Heading 3	<code>### Header 3</code>	Sub-section heading
Heading 4-6	<code>#### H4 ##### H5 ##### H6</code>	Deeply nested sub-headings
Horizontal Rule	<code>---</code> or <code>***</code> or <code>___</code>	Creates a horizontal divider line
Line Break	End a line with two spaces and press Enter	Forces a line break without a new paragraph

2. Text Emphasis

Element	Syntax Example	Rendered Look / Notes
Bold	<code>**text**</code> or <code>__text__</code>	Bold text (strong importance)
Italic	<code>*text*</code> or <code>_text_</code>	<i>Italic text</i> (emphasis)
Bold & Italic	<code>***text***</code>	<i>Bold and italicized text</i>
Strikethrough	<code>~~text~~</code>	Strikethrough text (GFM extended)

3. Lists

Element	Syntax Example	Rendered Look / Notes
Unordered List	<code>- Item 1</code> <code>- Item 2</code> <code> * Sub-item 2a</code>	• Item 1 • Item 2 • Sub-item 2a (Indent 2 or 4 spaces)
Ordered List	<code>1. First item</code> <code>2. Second item</code>	1. First item 2. Second item (Numbers don't have to be sequential)
Task List	<code>- [x] Completed task</code> <code>- [] Incomplete task</code>	☒ Completed task ☐ Incomplete task (GFM extended)

4. Links & Images

Element	Syntax Example	Rendered Look / Notes
Inline Link	<code>[Google](https://google.com)</code>	A hyperlink with custom descriptive text
Link with Title	<code>[Google](https://google.com "Search")</code>	Hovering displays the title tooltip
Anchor / ID Link	<code>[Section 1](#section-1)</code>	Links to an internal header anchor
Image Link	<code>![Alt Text](image.jpg)</code>	Embeds an image. Text shows if load fails
Linked Image	<code>[![Alt](img.jpg)](url)</code>	Wraps an image inside an active clickable link

5. Blocks & Code

Element	Syntax Example	Rendered Look / Notes
Blockquote	> This is a quote. > Multiple lines work.	Indents and styles block quotes from other text
Nested Blockquote	> Outer quote >> Inner nested quote	Creates a blockquote within a blockquote
Inline Code	<code>code snippet</code>	Highlights a brief phrase or command inline
Code Block	<code>```javascript const x = 5; console.log(x); ```</code>	Creates a multi-line code block with optional language syntax highlighting indicator

6. Tables

Element	Syntax Example	Rendered Look / Notes
Standard Table	Header 1 Header 2 --- --- Cell 1 Cell 2	Creates columns and rows using pipe and dash notation
Alignment Rules	Left Center Right :--- :---: :---: Text Text Text	Colons dictate text alignment within the column: • Left-aligned: :--- • Centered: :---: • Right-aligned: ---:

7. Miscellaneous & Extended Syntax

Element	Syntax Example	Rendered Look / Notes
Footnotes	Here is a note ^[1] . [1]: The footnote text.	Creates a small superscript link to reference notes at the bottom of the document
Escaping Characters	<code>*Not italic*</code>	Uses a backslash to render literal markdown characters
Inline HTML	<code><kbd>Ctrl</kbd></code>	Allows direct raw HTML formatting blocks inside markdown for specific elements
Emoji Shortcuts	:rocket: or :smile:	Supported on platforms like GitHub, Slack, and Discord